

Records Retention Policy

Effective Date: June 1, 2026 | Version 1.0

Purpose

This policy establishes how Good Company creates, maintains, secures, and destroys business and client records. Proper records retention supports continuity of care, accurate billing, legal compliance, and protection of client privacy. This policy applies to all records, both paper and digital, created or received by Good Company.

General Principles

- Records are created accurately and contemporaneously with the event they describe
- Records are stored securely, with access limited to authorized persons
- Records are retained for the period specified in this policy, then destroyed securely
- Records subject to active investigation, complaint, or litigation are preserved until the matter is fully resolved, regardless of standard retention timelines
- Records are reviewed to identify items eligible for destruction

Retention Schedule

The following table specifies retention periods for the categories of records maintained by Good Company. Retention periods begin on the date the record is created or the date services end, whichever applies.

Record Type	Retention Period	Storage Method
Daily Work Reports / Visit Records	7 years after final visit	Digital (encrypted)
Client Service Agreements	7 years after termination	Digital + paper copy
Client Intake Forms	7 years after termination	Digital + paper copy
Authorized Representative Documentation (POA, Guardianship)	7 years after termination	Digital + paper copy
Incident Reports (falls, injuries, near-misses)	10 years after incident	Digital (encrypted)
Emergency Response Records	10 years after incident	Digital (encrypted)
Elder Abuse Reports	Permanent (do not destroy)	Digital (encrypted)
Complaint Records	10 years after resolution	Digital + paper copy

Policy Acknowledgments (staff)	7 years after employment ends	Digital + paper copy
Background Checks	Length of relationship + 5 years	Digital (encrypted)
Insurance Certificates	Length of relationship + 7 years	Digital + paper copy
Bonding Records	Length of relationship + 7 years	Digital + paper copy
Tax Returns and Supporting Documents	7 years	Digital + paper copy
Financial Records (invoices, payments)	7 years	Digital
Mileage Logs	7 years	Digital
Banking Records	7 years	Digital
Business Licenses and Permits	Permanent	Digital + paper copy
LLC Formation Documents	Permanent	Digital + paper copy
Photographs of Clients (with consent)	Until consent withdrawn or termination + 1 year	Digital (encrypted)
Marketing Releases	Length of use + 3 years	Digital + paper copy
Email Correspondence (client-related)	3 years from last contact	Digital

Special Retention Situations

The following situations override the standard retention schedule:

- Active complaint or investigation: All related records are preserved until the matter is fully resolved, plus 7 years
- Active or threatened litigation: Records are preserved indefinitely until the matter is fully resolved, plus 7 years
- Government audit or inquiry: Records are preserved until the audit or inquiry is fully resolved, plus 7 years
- Subpoena or court order: Records are preserved as directed and not destroyed even if otherwise eligible
- Reports of suspected abuse: Records related to a report made to Michigan Adult Protective Services are retained permanently

Storage and Security

Records are stored according to their sensitivity and format:

- Digital records are stored in password-protected accounts (Google Workspace, accounting software, etc.)

- Sensitive digital records (medical info, financial info, identification documents) are encrypted
- Paper records are stored in a locked file cabinet at the Owner's home office
- Backup copies of digital records are maintained in a separate location (cloud backup)
- Access to records is limited to the Owner and authorized staff members
- Records are not stored on shared or unsecured devices
- Mobile devices used to access records require strong passwords or biometric locks

Access to Records

Records may be accessed by:

- The Owner (Natalie Perras), for any business purpose
- Authorized staff members, only for records related to clients they serve
- The Client themselves, upon written request, regarding their own records
- The Client's authorized representative (POA, guardian), regarding the Client's records
- Law enforcement or regulatory agencies, with appropriate legal authority (subpoena, court order, or as required by mandatory reporting law)
- Insurance carriers, as needed for claims or audits
- Legal counsel, when representing Good Company

Client Requests for Records

Clients (or their authorized representatives) have the right to request copies of their own records. To request records:

- Submit a written request to hello@goodcompanyscs.com or by mail
- Identify which records are requested (e.g., all visit reports for a date range)
- Provide proof of identity or authority (representative status)
- Good Company will respond within 14 business days
- Copies will be provided in digital format unless paper is specifically requested
- A reasonable fee may apply for large or paper requests

Destruction of Records

When records reach the end of their retention period, they are destroyed securely:

- Paper records are shredded using a cross-cut shredder, or destroyed by a certified destruction service
- Digital records are permanently deleted, including from backups, and storage media is securely wiped or destroyed
- Records subject to special retention situations are not destroyed until the special situation is resolved
- Destruction is documented in a destruction log including: type of record, date range, date of destruction, method, and signature of person performing destruction

Annual Records Review

Once each year (typically in January), the Owner reviews all records to:

- Identify records eligible for destruction
- Confirm secure storage of records still being retained
- Update access controls as needed
- Verify backup integrity
- Document the review and any actions taken

Confidentiality

All client and business records are confidential. Records are never shared with unauthorized parties, posted on social media, used for marketing without written consent, sold, or otherwise disclosed except as expressly permitted in this policy or required by law.

Breach Notification

If a records breach occurs (unauthorized access, loss, theft, or accidental disclosure), the Owner will:

- Take immediate steps to contain the breach and prevent further disclosure
- Document the breach including what records were affected, when, and how
- Notify affected clients in writing as soon as reasonably possible
- Notify law enforcement if the breach involved theft or criminal activity
- Consult with legal counsel regarding any further notification requirements under Michigan law
- Review and update security practices to prevent recurrence

Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually and updated as needed to reflect changes in law, business practices, or risk environment. All staff members are required to read and acknowledge this policy.

Policy reviewed and approved by:



Natalie Perras, Owner

Date: 6/9/2026